From strategic question to data-driven answer

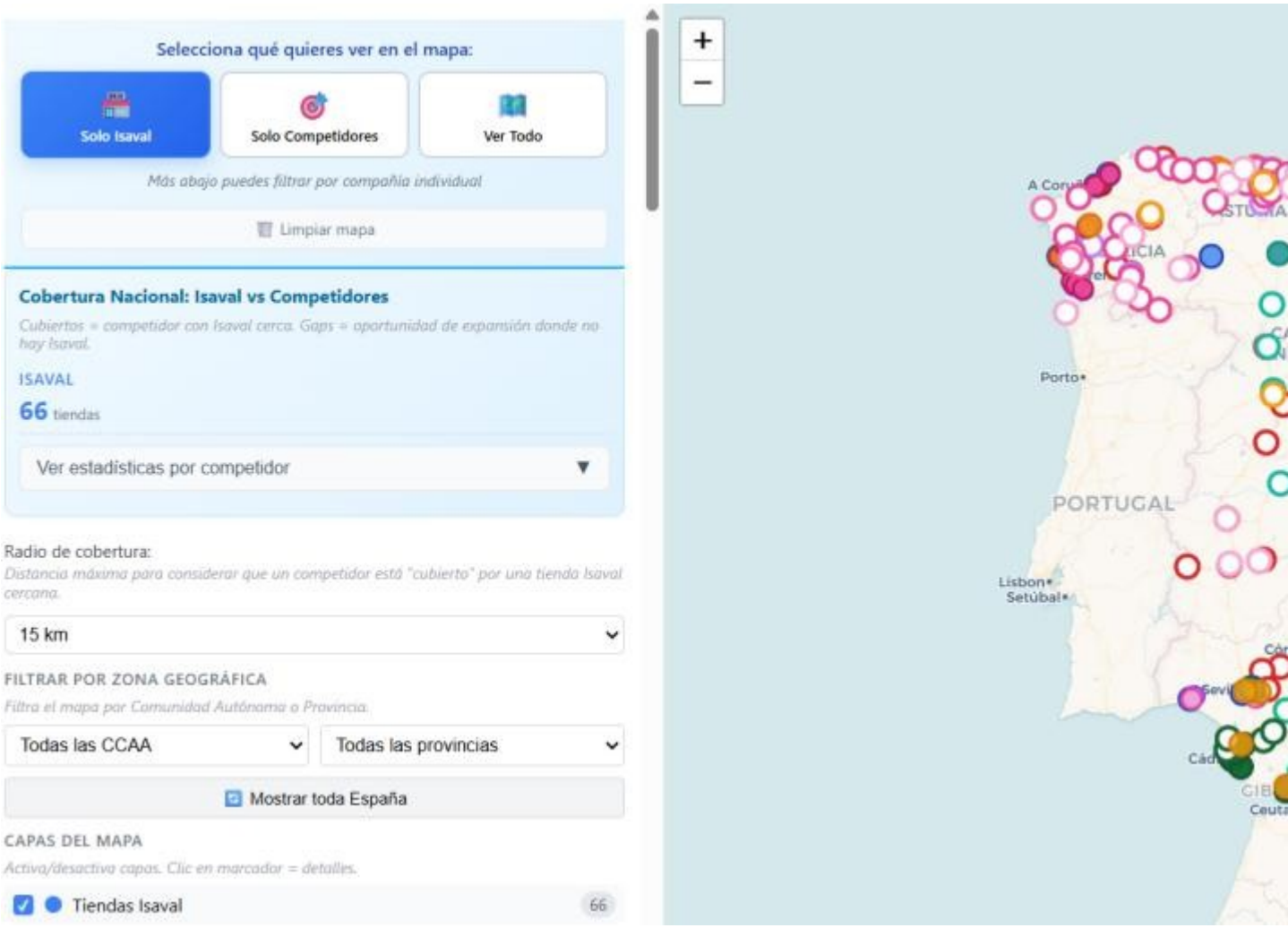
In management meetings, important questions often arise that are difficult to answer with immediate data. Do we have the right geographic footprint? Are our opening hours competitive? Where does it make sense to keep growing? These are legitimate and necessary questions for strategic planning, but they run into an operational reality: the information exists, yet it is scattered across teams, documents, websites and individual knowledge.

It is not that knowledge is missing. If you ask each area manager or sales person, they can usually tell you exactly who competes with them, how far away they are or what hours the store across the street keeps. The problem is that this knowledge lives in fragments, and it is difficult to see the full picture. In the past, obtaining that view would have required a consulting project lasting several weeks, with manual collection, source normalization and report preparation.

Two concrete cases

The first case emerged directly from a boardroom discussion about Isaval’s territorial presence. The question was clear: how is our store network positioned against competitors at the national level? With the help of AI, a web tool was built showing our stores on an interactive map alongside more than 450 competitor locations. The system makes it possible to filter by competitor, region or influence radius.

What would have been a static consulting report became a navigable tool that supports strategic conversations in real time. Someone asks what is happening in a given region, and within seconds there is a visual answer with enough detail to discuss it.



Interactive map comparing Isaval's store network with competitor presence by region and radius.

The second case followed the same logic. Faced with the question of whether our opening hours are competitive, the tool incorporated a comparison crossing our store hours with those of Monto and Valentine. At aggregate level, it shows indicators such as the percentage of stores with split shifts or Saturday opening. In detail, it automatically identifies the stores that differ most from nearby competitors and those that close on Saturday while a nearby competitor remains open.

Resumen Comparativo | Análisis por Tienda

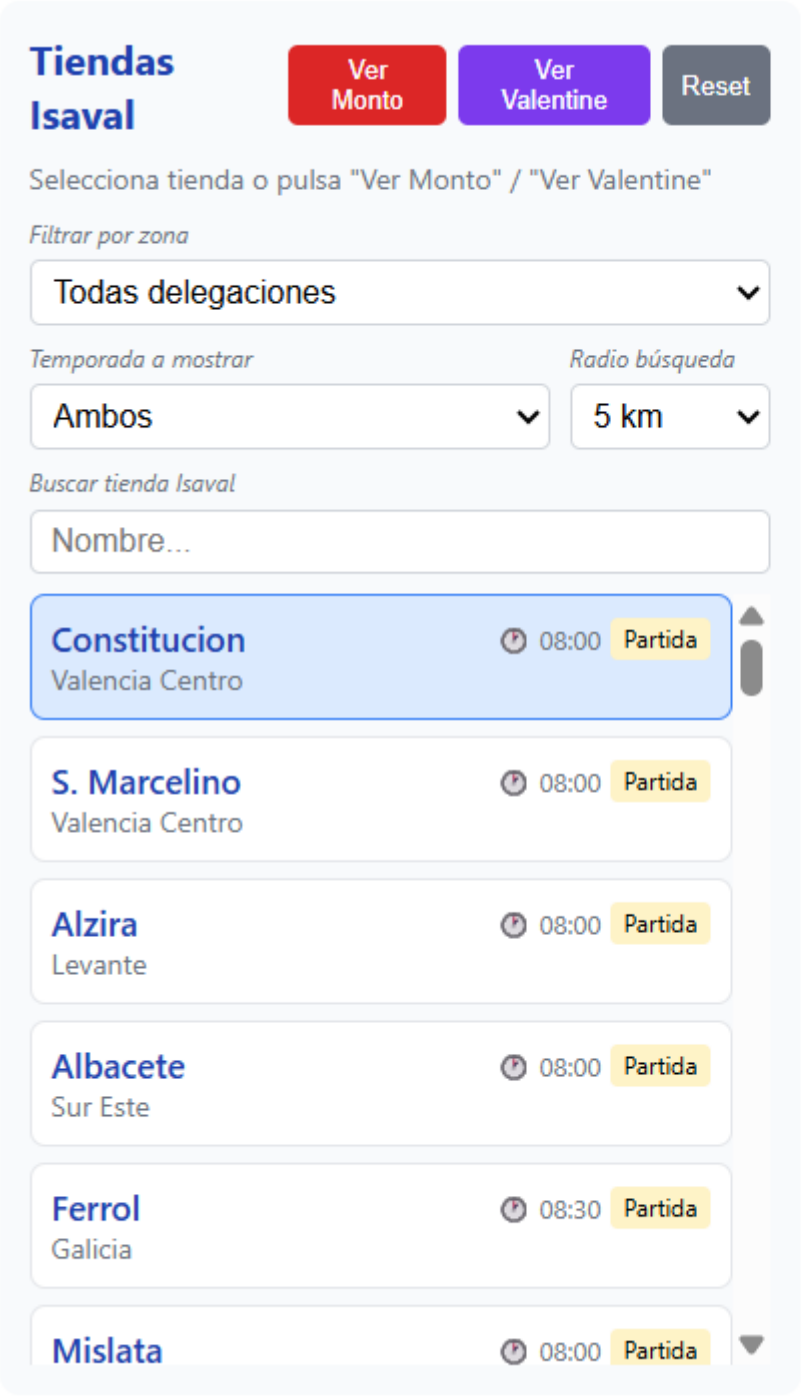
ISAVAL 66 tiendas	
Horas promedio L-V	8.8h
Hora común apertura	8:00
Hora común cierre	19:00
Jornada partida	89%
Jornada continua	11%
Sábados abiertos	82%
Horas media sábado	4.3h

MONTO 143 tiendas	
Horas promedio L-V	
Hora común apertura	
Hora común cierre	
Jornada partida	
Jornada continua	
Sábados abiertos	
Horas media sábado	

Ver: Tiendas que más difieren de competidores

Tienda Isaval	Horario Isaval	Dif.	Competidor cercano
Tenerife Delegacion Canarias	07:15-15:00 Continua 7.8h	-2.8h	Monto TIENDA MAJUELOS - TENERIFE 2.0 km
Manacor Baleares	07:00-19:00 Continua 12.0h	+4.0h	Monto TIENDA MONTO MANACOR - BALEAR 0.7 km
Paterna Valencia Centro	08:00-13:29 / 16:00-19:00 Partida 8.5h	-3.5h	Monto TIENDA BENIMAMET - VALENCIA 1.6 km
L'eliana Valencia Centro	08:00-13:29 / 16:00-19:00 Partida 8.5h	-3.5h	Monto TIENDA LA POBLA DE VALBONA - VAL 5.1 km

Consolidated view for answering territorial strategy questions with immediate visual reading.



Detailed opening-hours comparison to detect competitive differences in service availability.

Where this can lead

What these cases demonstrate is a replicable model. AI drastically reduces the cost of consolidating heterogeneous information into a structured view. This opens the door to applying the same logic to other strategic questions that today require weeks of manual data work or that simply remain unaddressed because the effort is too high.

AI does not replace strategic judgment or on-the-ground knowledge. Commercial teams still understand their zones and direct competitors best. What AI does is enable a layer of global visibility that used to be hard to achieve: turning scattered knowledge into a unified, navigable

picture, and helping questions that once stayed in the air become analyses that actually get done.

The question matters as much as the answer.

Many strategic questions remain unexplored because the cost of answering them is too high. When that cost drops sharply, the organization can think more often and more rigorously about issues that were previously postponed.

AI here does not replace judgment; it amplifies it.

The decision remains human. What changes is the ability to gather context, contrast information and make navigable a view that was previously costly, slow or inaccessible.

The pattern scales.

If it can be done for geographic footprint and opening hours, it can be extended to product comparisons, commercial network questions, competitor tracking or any other strategic issue based on scattered data and heterogeneous sources.

Ultimately, this case shows that AI can turn strategic questions that previously lacked an agile answer into real analysis tools for management.